

Dillan Desai

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Education

University of California, San Diego

Sept. 2025 - June 2028

B.S. in Data Science

La Jolla, CA

- GPA: 3.67

Experience

University of California, San Diego

Oct. 2025 - Present

Data Analyst for Baseball Team

La Jolla, CA

- Attending games to tag and monitor live player tracking statistics using Trackman
- Developed team's Location+ and Pitching+ player evaluation models

Tread Athletics

June 2026 - Aug. 2026

Data Support Intern

Remote

- Annotated thousands of image frames to enhance computer vision models

Southern Section Stats

Mar. 2023 - Mar. 2025

Founder

Sierra Madre, CA

- Analyzed team statistics for over 100 high school basketball teams in Southern California
- Covered several tournaments and tracked stats for 229 teams at the Section 7 national tournament
- Curated a personal stat profile for an ESPN Top 100 Harvard basketball commit

Projects

Location+ Model

- Developed and refined XGBoost models to assign expected run values to individual pitches
- Collected and cleaned data using Pandas and expanded model pipelines using scikit-learn library
- Calculated location+ values for over 1,000 pitchers and over 100,000 pitches to evaluate pitcher performance

Paper on NBA Rebuilding

- Conducted a collective case study analysis on 8 NBA teams over the last 15 years
- Specifically analyzed 4 successful team rebuilds and 4 unsuccessful team rebuilds
- Found 5 factors influencing success/failure: player signings, payroll, draft picks, trades, team culture

SMT Data Challenge

- This summer, I participated in the SMT Data Challenge, a student analytics competition involving anonymized minor league ball- and player-tracking data.
- In accordance with this year's prompt, the results of my project are intended for display on a minor league scoreboard, so as to help drive fan engagement. I used Python to do my data cleaning and analysis.
- Because the rules of the competition prohibit sharing or discussing my project before finalists are announced in October, the organizers have asked me to provide this prepared text in lieu of something more comprehensive. If you have questions or would like more information, please contact Meredith Wills at m.wills@smt.com.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, HTML/CSS

Libraries: Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib